

Constellations

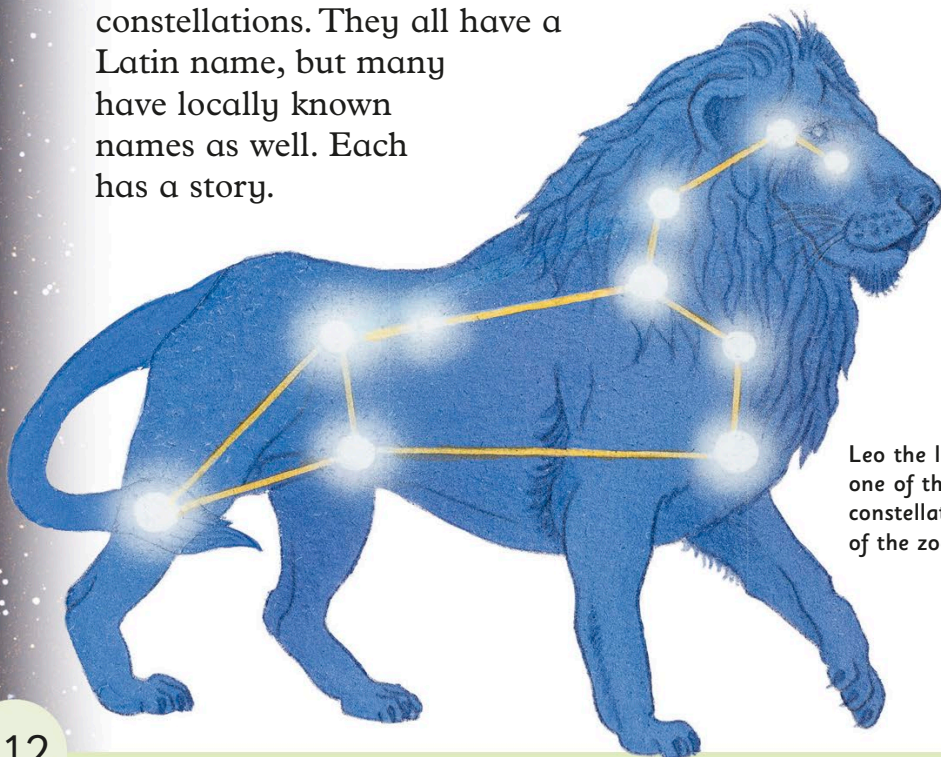
Constellations are collections of stars that can be seen from the Earth, and which have been named as groups. This is the part of space that we can all see and begin to recognize from a very young age.

The celestial sphere

Astronomers once believed that the stars were stuck inside a gigantic globe that enclosed the Earth. They named it the celestial sphere. We now know that it doesn't really exist, but it is a helpful way of pinpointing the location of the stars.

How many constellations?

Leo the lion, Orion the hunter... there are 88 internationally recognized constellations. They all have a Latin name, but many have locally known names as well. Each has a story.



Leo the lion is one of the 12 constellations of the zodiac.

Turn and learn

The northern sky:
pp. 114-115

The southern sky:
pp. 116-117